

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

Interconnection of Large Loads to the	)	
Interstate Transmission System	)	Docket No. RM26-4-000
	)	
	)	

**REPLY COMMENTS OF
ENCHANTED ROCK, LLC**

Pursuant to the Federal Energy Commission (“FERC” or “Commission”)’s October 27, 2025, *Notice Inviting Comments* in the captioned proceeding,¹ Enchanted Rock, LLC (“Enchanted Rock”) hereby respectfully submits these reply comments (“Reply Comments”) for the Commission’s consideration in response to several initial comments related to the Secretary of Energy’s proposed Advanced Notice of Proposed Rulemaking.² As previously indicated,³ Enchanted Rock generally supports the Secretary of Energy’s position regarding the need to ensure “access to affordable, reliable, and secure electricity” by facilitating the connection of large loads “to the transmission system in a timely, orderly, and non-discriminatory manner.”⁴ Enchanted Rock hereby responds to the initial comments submitted by Vistra Corp. (“Vistra”), the California Independent System Operator Corporation (“CAISO”), Constellation Energy Generation, LLC (“Constellation”), Meta Platforms Inc. (“Meta”), and Google LLC (“Google”). These Reply Comments reiterate the urgent need to facilitate load flexibility as a mechanism to

¹ See *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System*, Notice Inviting Comments, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Oct. 27, 2025).

² See *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System*, Secretary of Energy’s Proposed Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Oct. 23, 2025) (“ANOPR”).

³ See Comments of Enchanted Rock, LLC, Docket No. RM26-4-00, at 1 (Nov. 21, 2025) (“Enchanted Rock Initial Comments”) (“Enchanted Rock supports the Commission’s efforts to initiate a rulemaking proceeding in order to consider reforms that will ensure the timely and orderly interconnection of large loads to the transmission system”).

⁴ See *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission System*, Secretary of Energy’s Direction that the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission Initiate Rulemaking Procedures and Proposal Regarding the Interconnection of Large Loads Pursuant to the Secretary’s Authority Under Section 403 of the Department of Energy Organization Act, Docket No. RM26-4-000 (Oct. 23, 2025).

accomplish speed-to-power, which will reinforce grid reliability, support energy affordability, and offer a technology-neutral pathway to secure necessary generation.

I. REPLY COMMENTS

a. Need for Clear, Predictable Interconnection Rules

The influx of large load facilities associated with the modern era of Artificial Intelligence (“AI”) innovation is contributing to an unprecedented scaling of electricity demand requiring solutions that consider long-term transmission planning, while acknowledging near-term realities. Winning the AI race and bolstering the U.S. economy relies on the ability of federal and state regulators to create stable and predictable rules that encourage infrastructure investment and business confidence.

Notably, Enchanted Rock agrees with Vistra that the regulation of transmission-level load interconnections by the Commission “does not imply a diminution of state authority in the areas that the [Federal Power Act (“FPA”)] reserves for state jurisdiction.”⁵ Vistra’s comments align with Enchanted Rock’s initial comments seeking further clarification on the dividing line between federal and state regulation of large load interconnection,⁶ and demonstrate the need for the Commission to promulgate a final rule that is clear, predictable and legally durable.

b. Need for Alignment with NERC Reliability Standards

In support of establishing rules to clarify the treatment of large load interconnections, Enchanted Rock previously recommended that the Commission direct the North American

⁵ See Comments of Vistra Corp, Docket No. RM26-4-000, at 13-14 (Nov. 21, 2025). Enchanted Rock notes that the division of authority contemplated by the FPA provides that the Commission has jurisdiction over “the transmission of electric energy in interstate commerce and to the sale of electric energy at wholesale in interstate commerce” but makes clear that the Commission shall “not have jurisdiction, except as specifically provided in this subchapter and subchapter III of this chapter, over facilities used for the generation of electric energy or over facilities used in local distribution or only for the transmission of electric energy in intrastate commerce, or over facilities for the transmission of electric energy consumed wholly by the transmitter.” 16 U.S.C. § 824d(b)(1).

⁶ See Enchanted Rock Initial Comments at 4-5.

Electric Reliability Corporation (“NERC”) “to review and revise its standards to recognize the flexibility created by large loads deploying on-site or co-located generation as a standard operational and planning tool.”⁷ As Enchanted Rock indicated “[a]cknowledging load flexibility during the transmission planning and interconnection processes allows transmission planners to assume lower peak demand for the associated load facility, thereby reducing the immediate need for transmission upgrades and expediting interconnection timelines.”⁸

Enchanted Rock acknowledges CAISO’s comments that large loads connecting to the transmission system pose significant impacts on system reliability,⁹ and supports efforts to harmonize NERC’s reliability standards with the reforms being considered in this ANOPR proceeding.¹⁰ Enchanted Rock believes that such harmonization will promote the timely, orderly and predictable interconnection of large loads.

c. Need for Flexible Load Interconnection and Hybrid Resources

Transmission system operators and planners urgently require a solution capable of efficiently managing the high volume of large load interconnections and accommodating the aggregate demand introduced by these facilities. As supported by the record in the captioned proceeding to-date, operational flexibility provides a valuable means of supporting speed-to-power.¹¹ Indeed, hyperscale end-users, such as Google, have embraced the concept of gaining speed through flexibility. For example, Google recommends that the Commission, in the near term, prioritize “facilitating the integration of co-located generation, including electric storage

⁷ Enchanted Rock Initial Comments at 5.

⁸ *Id.* at 5-6.

⁹ See Comments of the California Independent System Operator Corporation, Docket No. RM26-4-000, at 1-2, 2-4, 17 (Nov. 21, 2025).

¹⁰ See also *id.* at 17 (“Given the rapid proliferation of these large loads, it is critical for the Commission, NERC, States, and utilities to adapt their standards and procedures as necessary to maintain reliability.”).

¹¹ See, e.g., Comments of L. Lynn Kiesleing, Ph.D., Docket No. RM26-4-000, at 5 (Nov. 21, 2025) (“[F]lexibility has become the binding constraint and the highest-value capability in modern power systems.”).

resources, and load and electrically proximate load and generation, which unlock planning and siting efficiencies that minimize transmission impact.”¹² This observation highlights the value of co-location and its practical application to facilitate speed-to-power, expedite study timelines, protect ratepayer affordability, and reduce strain on transmission infrastructure. Indeed, Enchanted Rock supports the Commission considering “near-term steps that can help set the stage for longer-term solutions.”¹³

Enchanted Rock’s initial comments in this proceeding also reflected these sentiments, in particular, in discussing Enchanted Rock’s load co-located with dispatchable generation (“LCDG”) model.¹⁴ Further, a joint study process would allow LCDG and hybrid facilities to be studied based on their operational behavior and net load impacts, which Enchanted Rock believes will result in less strain on the transmission system, unlock available grid headroom, optimize existing transmission infrastructure and more accurately model the flexible capabilities of the system. As such, Enchanted Rock encourages the Commission to adopt rules that will facilitate joint study processes (even if only for a provisional period) and that evaluate co-located and hybrid facilities based on their net impacts to the grid. Flexible models, such as LCDG, offer a practical approach to meet accelerating energy “without driving up costs or abandoning progress on efficiency, resilience and carbon reduction.”¹⁵ Growing demand “coupled with

¹² Comments of Google LLC, Docket No. RM26-4-000, at 6 (Nov. 21, 2025).

¹³ See P. Asmus, *Data Centers can Procure Affordable, Sustainable Energy in Today’s Constrained Power Markets*, Pathfinder Communications, at 2 (Sept. 2025), available at: <https://enchantedrock.com/procuring-energy-for-data-centers/>.

¹⁴ As Enchanted Rock explained, under the LCDG option, “load and generation may be separately metered but are studied together for purposes of retail load interconnection and integration, transmission and resource adequacy planning, and operations.” See *Large Loads Co-located at Generating Facilities*, Response of Enchanted Rock, LLC, Docket No. AD24-11-000, *et al.*, Section II (Apr. 23, 2025) (“Enchanted Rock Docket No. AD24-11 Comments”).

¹⁵ See P. Asmus, *Data Centers can Procure Affordable, Sustainable Energy in Today’s Constrained Power Markets*, Pathfinder Communications, at 4 (Sept. 2025), available at: <https://enchantedrock.com/procuring-energy-for-data-centers/>.

supply delays caused by lengthy permitting processes for generation and transmission infrastructure, as well as persistent supply chain delays for equipment, means the industry must devise immediately implementable solutions that optimize existing infrastructure and ensure that transmission expansion occurs in the most cost-effective way possible.”¹⁶

Further, Enchanted Rock acknowledges Constellation’s statement regarding the use of interruptible service, that “if the customer chooses, interruptible service can serve as a bridge to full service while transmission upgrades are completed.”¹⁷ Constellation appears essentially to be describing a temporary, flexible service arrangement that, if allowed by the Commission, would grant large loads the ability to operate prior to transmission expansions on an as-available basis. Enchanted Rock notes that this concept aligns with aspects of Enchanted Rock’s proposed LCDG model because it would facilitate “a temporary flexibility option that large loads can opt into . . . therefore mitigate[ing] some . . . risks and allow[ing] for faster load interconnection.”¹⁸

Other mechanisms of bridging, such as temporary power solutions, are applicable to co-location configurations as well. Meta characterizes this as allowing “large loads to secure electric power quickly, and, in some instances, streamline the build out of necessary transmission infrastructure.”¹⁹ Data centers are able to connect to the grid faster “with options for incremental capacity additions in the future.”²⁰ Co-locating generation with load allows system planners to

¹⁶ Enchanted Rock Docket No. AD24-11 Comments at 3.

¹⁷ See Supporting Comments of Constellation Energy Generation, LLC, Docket No. RM26-4-000, *et al.*, at 24 (Nov. 21, 2025).

¹⁸ See *id.* at 5. Moreover, as Enchanted Rock previously indicated, “[e]fforts such as Southwest Power Pool, Inc. (“SPP”)’s High Impact Large Load Generation Assessment (“HILLGA”) and anticipated Conditional High Impact Large Load Service (“CHILLS”) proposal are examples of proposals that will create expedited pathways for interconnecting large loads. The Commission should consider these examples as models for adoption by other Commission-jurisdictional grid operators.” Enchanted Rock Initial Comments at 4 (citations omitted).

¹⁹ Comments of Meta Platforms, Inc., Docket No. RM26-4-000, at 5 (Nov. 21, 2025).

²⁰ See P. Asmus, *Data Centers can Procure Affordable, Sustainable Energy in Today’s Constrained Power Markets*, Pathfinder Communications, at 7 (Sept. 2025), available at: <https://enchantedrock.com/procuring-energy-for-data-centers/> (noting that load collocated with on-site generation is an approach that “is now commercially viable with recent regulatory reforms allowing DERs to offer a ‘bridge-to-grid’ service that is economically and environmentally sound”).

study the assets as a combined facility, triggering fewer transmission upgrades and mitigating the associated costs that would otherwise be passed onto rate payers.

II. CONCLUSION

Enchanted Rock appreciates the opportunity to submit these Reply Comments and commends the Commission on initiating this proceeding. Enchanted Rock has drawn the ideas and solutions discussed herein from various corners of the industry, with such ideas representing key areas of common ground needed to move forward. Enchanted Rock urges the Commission to prioritize the development of clear transmission interconnection rules and consider the value of flexibility in accelerating large load interconnections, while protecting ratepayer affordability and grid reliability.

Respectfully submitted,

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CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I hereby certify that I have this day, caused the foregoing to be served upon each person designated on the official service list compiled by the Secretary in the captioned proceeding.

Dated at Washington, D.C., this 5th day of December, 2025.

/s/ Steven Shparber